

Setting up Gemini

A no-nonsense start. Ten minutes, not a course.

1. Create your account

If you already have a Gmail account, you already have Gemini. Go to gemini.google.com and sign in with it, no separate sign-up needed.

2. Connect it to Gmail and Calendar

Ask it to do something with either: "what's on my calendar today" or "check my inbox for anything from [name]", and it'll prompt you to authorise the connection the first time. Follow the on-screen steps once, and it stays connected after that.

3. What it can and can't actually do with your calendar

Worth knowing upfront: it can create, find, reschedule and cancel events for you in plain English, but it can't add guests or edit locations and descriptions yet, you'll still need to open Calendar directly for that. Knowing this now means it won't catch you out later.

4. What's actually worth turning on

Not much else needs configuring here, that's genuinely Gemini's strength, it just works inside the Google apps you already use rather than needing a setup ritual. Worth checking Settings occasionally as Google adds new connected-app options.

5. One thing to actually try today

Ask it to summarise what's actually on your plate this week using your real calendar and inbox, not a test question. That's the whole value of this one in a single prompt.
